

Standby switch and headphone output for the FORMANT-COM module

These modifications to the COM module will primarily benefit FORMANT players who wish to showcase the vast array of timbral variations their instrument offers to a larger audience—specifically, in live performance settings. However, the following considerations should also prove interesting to those who play their FORMANT only in the quiet seclusion of a private studio—not least for the sake of maintaining good relations with their neighbors.

The voltage-controlled music synthesizer is arguably the most versatile musical instrument of all. Yet, for this very reason, many of the resulting sound combinations are not particularly suited to the ears of the average listener. To ensure that the average listener does not lose their appetite for the musical "treats" a synthesizer can produce, it is advisable to set up the desired sound using headphones first. With the modifications described below, the audience is spared the "tuning" process on the FORMANT, while the user avoids the hassle of plugging and unplugging cables—actions that can otherwise cause the power amplifiers (PA) to produce loud, jarring crackling noises.

Headphone output

While output OUT 1 is used for the (external) power amplifiers (PA)—adjust trimmer P5 to match the PA input—OUT 2 is intended for the (monitor) headphones.

Output IS on the connector side of the COM board is connected to the PA input via a trimmer (100 k Ω), as shown in Figure 1.

This allows output OUT 2 to be optimally matched to the headphones, ensuring that the VOL control does not need readjustment when switching between PA and headphones (OUT 1/2). A suitable jack (usually a 6.35 mm jack socket) must be installed on the front panel for the headphones.

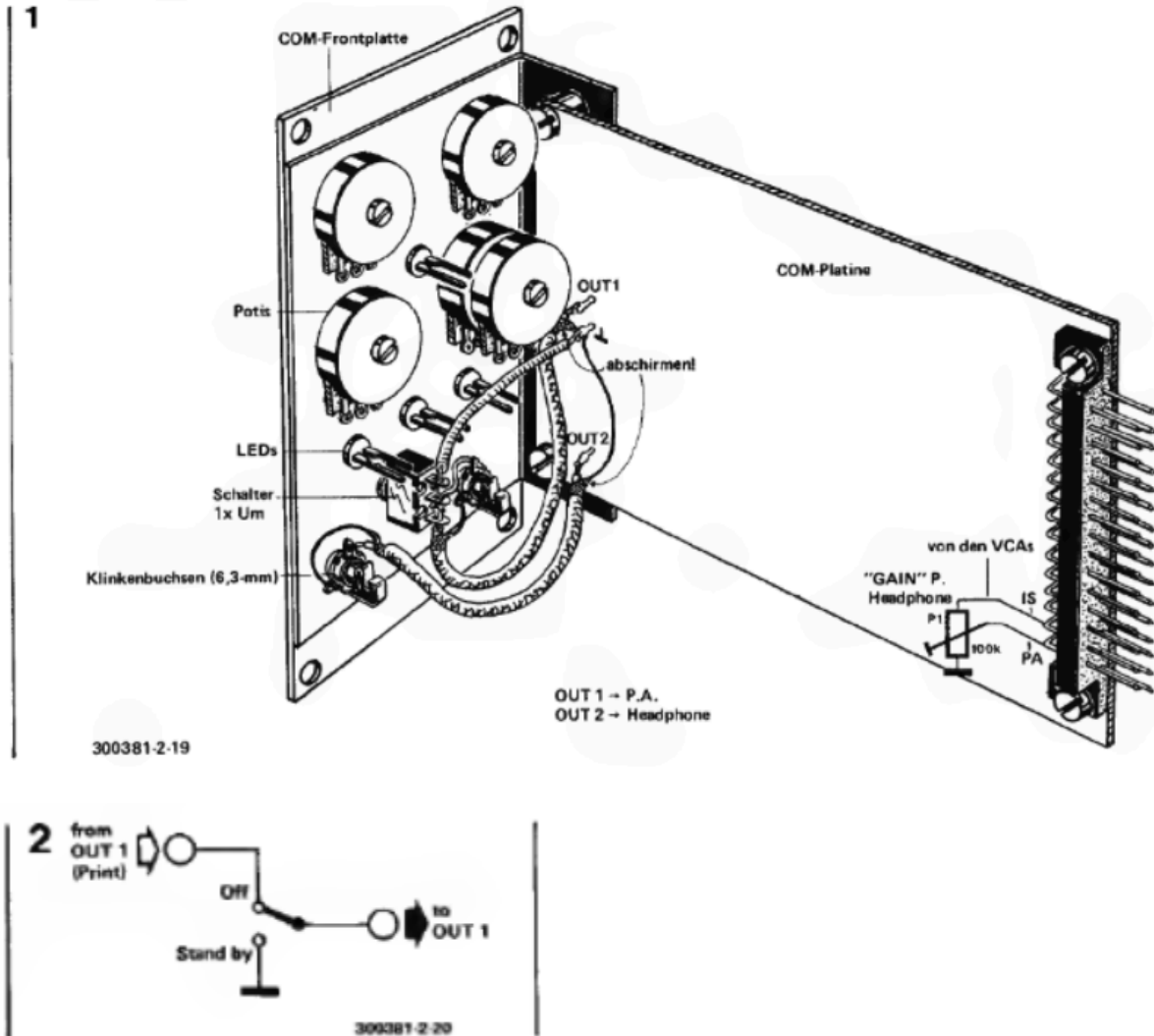
Standby switch

A miniature SPDT toggle switch should be mounted on the COM front panel—ideally in the open space between jacks OUT 1 and OUT 2. The procedure for drilling the front panel is described in detail in Chapter 1 (Portamento switch).

This additional switch allows the PA output to be either connected through or grounded; the wiring connections are shown in Figure 2. Figure 1 illustrates a suggested mounting arrangement. With these modifications complete, nothing stands in the way of the FORMANT's first "live" performance!

Figures

- Figure 1. Mounting and wiring of the extended COM module.
- Figure 2. Pin assignment of the standby switch.



Literature:

- C. Chapman: FORMANT Music Synthesizer, Elektor Verlag.
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- T. Orr: Music Synthesizer, Elrad 10/78, Verlag H. Heise.
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